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Public Speaking

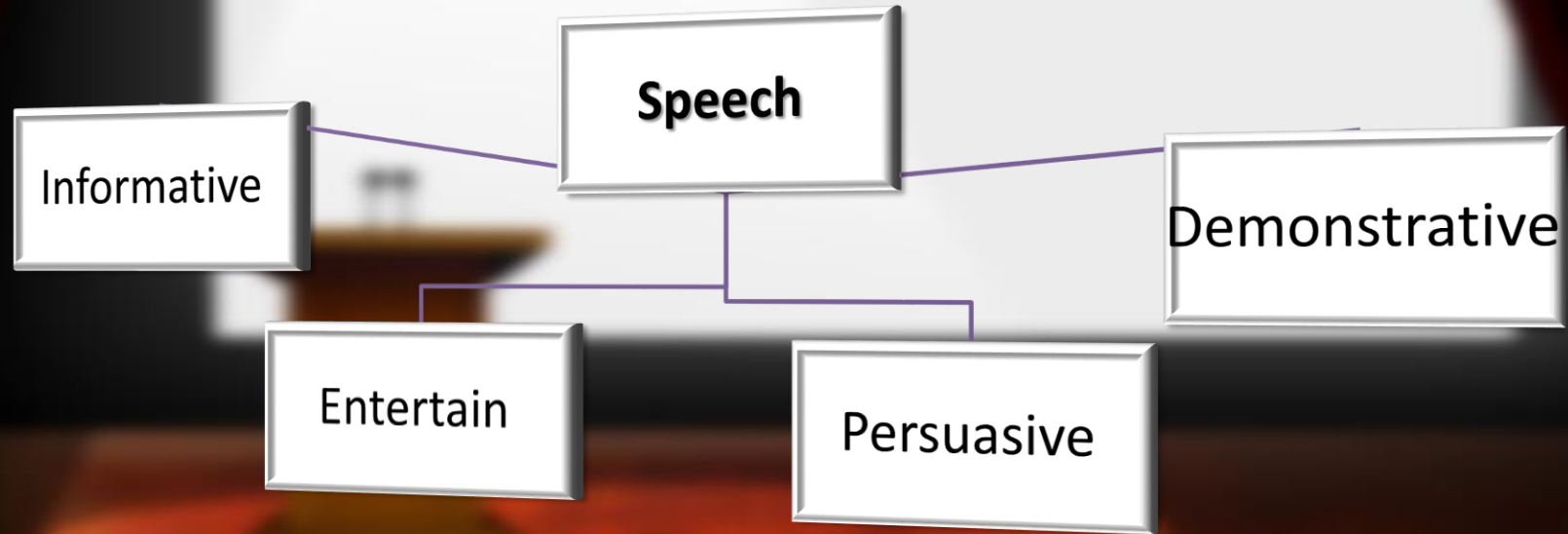
Lecture 34: Types of Speeches

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Types of Speeches



Informative Speech

- ☐ Speech springs out of our everyday living with the purpose to inform.
- ☐ From a teacher to an employer, everyone performs the act of informing.
- ☐ Aim of informational public speaking is to convey knowledge and understanding.
- ☐ It is not used for advocating any cause.

Criteria for Informational Speeches

- ❑ According to Lucas in his seminal work *The Art of Public Speaking*, there are three general criteria for judging a speech-
 - Accuracy
 - Clarity
 - Audiences' interest

Types of Informative Speeches



Speech about Objects

Speech about Processes

Speech about Events

Speech about Concepts

Speech about Objects

- ❑ This addresses anything that is tangible, visible, and stable in form.
- ❑ Three components of speech about objects:
 - Specific Purpose
 - Central idea
 - Main Points

Subjects/Topics:
People, Place,
Structure,
Animals

Who has not heard the name of Mahatma Gandhi- an apostle of peace and non-violence? A lawyer by profession and a politician, Gandhiji is revered not only in India but all around the world for his principles of truth, peace and non-violence. As a freedom fighter, he led movements like Salt March, Non-cooperation, Quit India etc. Instrumental in the freedom struggle, Gandhi led a simple life and as a social reformer, he fought not only for India's freedom but also raised his voice against several social evils like untouchability and child marriage etc.

If the specific purpose is to describe the fundamental features of the chosen subject, one may organize the speech in spatial order:

Specific Purpose: To inform the audience about the design of the Taj Mahal

Central Idea: The Taj Mahal is divided into five sections, each with its own attractions.

- Main Points:**
- (a) The moonlight garden situated north of the Yamuna river,
 - (b) The Riverfront terrace consisting of the Mausoleum, Mosque, and Guest House,
 - (c) The Charbagh Garden with beautiful pavilions,
 - (d) The Naubat Khana is divided into two parts, of which the western part has been converted into a museum
 - (e) The Jilaukhana consisting accommodational facilities for tomb attendants.

Speeches about Process

- ❑ A process is a systematic series of actions that leads to a specific result or product. Speeches about processes explain how something is made, how something is done, or how something works. (Lucas)
 - ❑ Two kinds of informative speeches about processes:
 - i. To make listeners understand the steps and their relations to each other better
- Specific purpose : To inform the audience about how plants grow in hilly regions
- ❖ Climatic conditions, soil type and not instruct them to grow the plants themselves

- ii. To explain a certain process enabling listeners to perform the process themselves

For instance, the purpose is to inform the audience on how to make a particular dish or to learn gardening. So, the goal becomes to equip the audience with the skill. One can begin talking about gardening with a catchy phrase-

Have you ever thought of how one can make one's idle hours enjoyable, experiential and enriching? If you allow me, I can tell you of one such hobby that you all are aware of and yet tend to remain unaware. Simple, very simple. It is Gardening, dear friends. Gardening grows the spirit, makes you bubble every day and after a few months, the blooms that appear on plants provide you with a sense of achievement.
Gardening is a work of the heart.

Speech about Events

- ❑ According to Random House Dictionary, an event is “anything that happens or is regarded as happening.”
- ❑ An event can be approached from almost any angle or combinations of angles- features, origins, implications, benefits, and so on and so forth.
- ❑ The speech should be analytical and in topical order.
- ❑ Topics like Earthquakes, Independence Day, Sleep Disorders, *The Ramayana*, World Cup, Job Interviews, Use of Cell phones etc.



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Speech about Concepts

- ❑ It includes speeches on beliefs, ideas, principles, theories, and more.
- ❑ This particular subtype is more abstract than objects, processes, or events.
- ❑ They are more complex than other kinds of informative speeches.
- ✓ Define the concepts, use examples and comparisons but avoid using technical language.



Ideas should be
personalised

Don't overestimate or
underestimate the
audience

Avoid usage of
technical language

Guidelines for Informative Speaking

Relate the subject of
the speech directly with
audience

Stay away from
Abstractions

Speeches to Entertain

- These speeches have the fundamental purpose of captivating the audience's attention with amusement intact.
- Speakers usually deliver entertaining speeches at occasions like weddings, open mic sessions, etc.
- It should have four key tenets- Preparation, adaptation to the audience, adaptation to the occasion, and time quotient.



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Persuasion as Speech Type

We have already discussed two types of speeches in the previous lecture.

- ☐ Persuasion, according to Lucas, is the process of creating, reinforcing, or changing people's beliefs or actions.
- ☐ This skill is extremely beneficial in every walk of life.
- ☐ Career aspirations like lawyers, sales, public relations, and so on and so forth can be met by conquering this skill.
- ☐ Persuasion is not only equipping us with the power of words but also making us aware of what and what not to believe.

Demonstrative Speech

- The audience receives information on how to do something during this speech.
- It can be informational demonstrative speech where while providing effective information, the speaker strongly suggests doing something.
- It is an effective technique for pitching an idea and selling any product or story to potential buyers.



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Most of you often wish if you could have wings, you could have flown to different parts climbing high mountains, crossing vast seas and oceans and enjoyed the freedom of experiencing the delights in no time. Imaginary though it may appear to many but you must believe that with the wings of **Bliss Airlines**, your wishes can come true. We lend you wings and make you fly to your desired destinations .

Questions of Fact



- Any assertion that meets truth or false is only through questioning.
- The questions related to facts can have absolute and conclusive answers.
- Inconclusive issues do not have black and white answers.



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Analysis of Fact-based Questions

- When we take into account the questions of facts, this type of persuasive speech overlaps informative speech.
- However, both the speech type is situation-based.
- In an informative speech, the speaker acts as a teacher or preacher whereas in a persuasive speech, the speaker advocates her/his point of view with the aim to persuade alone.

Analysis of Questions of Value



Opinion

IN MY OPINION

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Schools need adequate staffing,
not silver bullets, to restore quality

By Walt Hellman
Special to the Argus

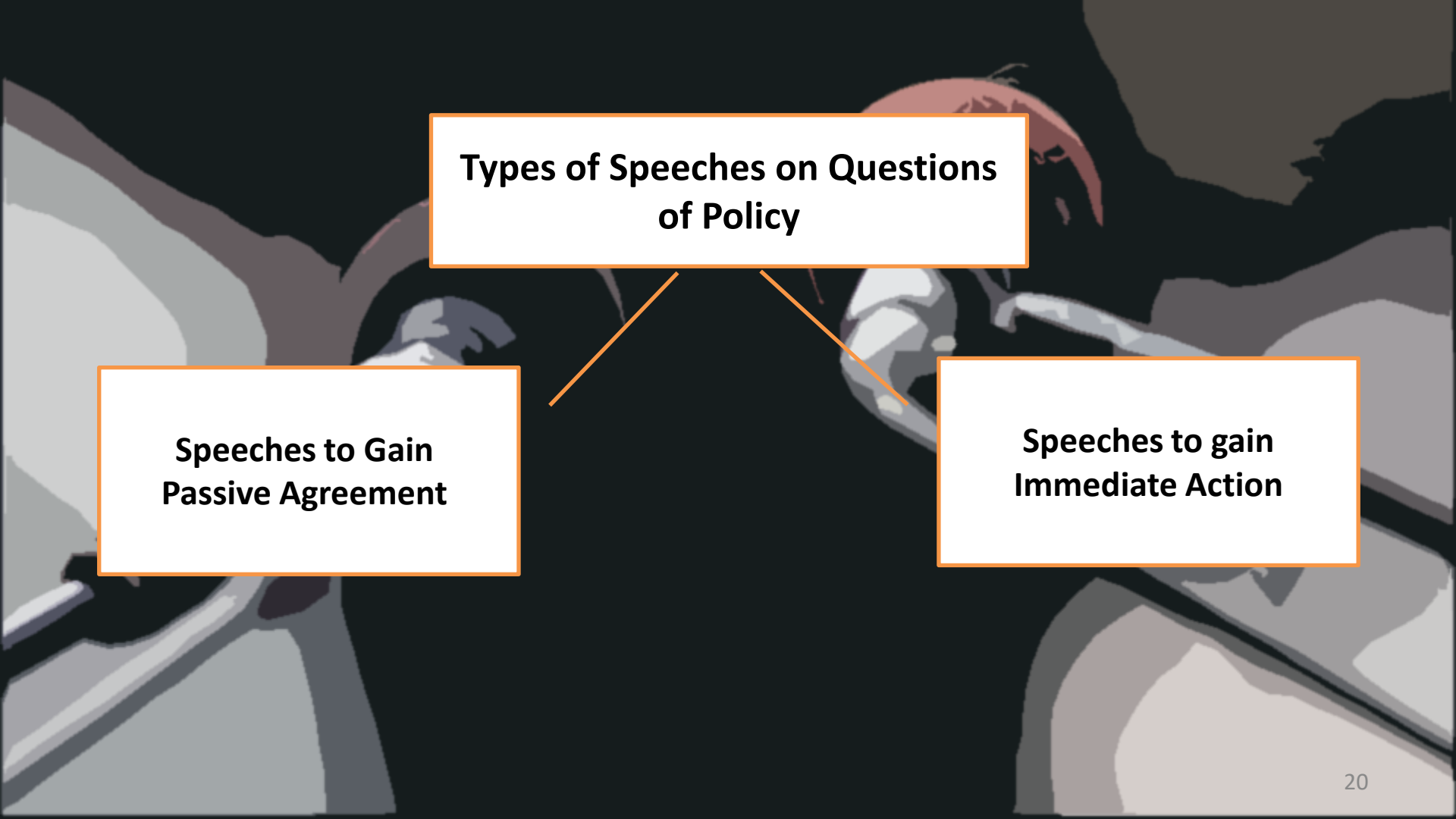
How long will Oregon be a state that sets ambitious education improvement goals while simultaneously reducing teachers' ability to deliver basic education?



an average of 40 in Hillsboro high schools and Oregon can't afford to keep its schools open all year. Tragically, for these 20 years, Oregon's educational and political leaders have not focused people's attention on the important need for replacement funding and increased

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- Any statement can be more persuasive if the value is evoked.
- For example, If one enjoys reading the newspaper, one should not simply state “I love reading the newspaper.” Instead, one should say, “Newspapers have been a rich source of information for a long time now.”



Types of Speeches on Questions of Policy

**Speeches to Gain
Passive Agreement**

**Speeches to gain
Immediate Action**

Analyzing Questions of Policy

- There are three fundamental issues that need to be taken care of prior to the question of policy being taken into consideration- **Need, plan and practicality.**

☐ Need

One has to surface the dire need in order to convince any audience of a policy.

☐ Plan

After acknowledging the problem, one should have a solution included in the policy that would eradicate the identified problem.

☐ Practicality

This is an essential component of any policy. It should not consist of words alone.

Organizing Speeches on Questions of Policy

❑ Problem-Solution Order

❑ Problem-Cause-Solution Order

❑ Comparative Advantages Order

- It is “a method of organizing persuasive speeches in which the first main point deals with the existence of a problem and the second main point presents a
- In this, the **identification** of a problem is done and is followed by analyzing the causes of the problem. It is after that essential analysis, that the solution is presented.
- Audience already is in **mutual agreement** that the problem exists. Allows the speaker to propose the selected point of view as the best solution.

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**“No speech is ever considered, but only the speaker. It's so much easier to pass judgement on a man than on an idea.”
— Ayn Rand, The Fountainhead**

Thank You